MyProCoach™

TRAINING PLAN

Marathon Running

RUNNING	BEGINNER	8 WEEKS

Welcome

As an athlete and a parent I know how challenging it can be to train effectively for events like triathlons, marathons or cycling events. I have over 20 years of experience helping amateur athletes surpass their goals, while still making sure they have quality time available for family, friends and career.

To help you train effectively, I have decided to offer a subset of our extremely popular plans for free. Usually, our plans include email coach access, personal intensity zones and advanced tracking software. But these plans provide the basics for free to give you a taste.

It would mean the world to me if you tried a 1-month free trial of Unlimited Athlete, my low-cost coaching program, but for now, feel free to get used to my style of training. Please use and share this plan as much as you like.

FAQS

Who is the plan suitable for?

This training plan is suitable for Beginner or time-limited runners, aiming to get in peak shape for a marathon event.

With just 8 weeks to go until event-day, this plan assumes you are currently able to run for up to 1hr 30mins. The plan builds up to race day, and helps improve your fitness and confidence.

People who follow a training plan have been shown to be twice as likely to succeed in reaching their goal.

How much training is involved?

Average weekly training hours are 4:00 with the biggest week at 5:05 hours. This includes 3 to 4 run and a 45 minute strength and conditioning session.

There is usually 1 workout per day, with 2 or 3 days off each week. The fourth week is an active recovery week, with less training, to help your body recover and adapt.

How to get started

Do your best to follow the workouts below, ideally in their given order.

To help you train at the right levels, we use five training zones, based on feel or heart rate.

If you use heart rate, we have a calculator that can create your training zones:

www.myprocoach.net/hr-zones

TRAINING ZONES

	Intensity Description	% of Your Max Heart Rate
Z1	Easy (Recovery)	♥ 68-73%
Z2	Steady (Endurance)	♥ 73-80%
Z3	Moderately Hard (Tempo)	♥ 80-87%
Z4	Hard (Threshold)	♥ 87-93%
Z5	Very Hard (VO2 Max)	♥ 93-100%

GLOSSARY

Key	Description
Z1	Training Zone 1
Z2	Training Zone 2
Z3	Training Zone 3
Z4	Training Zone 4
Z5	Training Zone 5

Week 1

Build Phase 1: 4 hrs 19 mins

Phil's tip

This plan includes a strength and conditioning workout each week.
Download your strength and conditioning PDF: https://bit.ly/RunSandC

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1	41 mins		35 mins	45 mins	33 mins		1 hr 30 mins
	Tempo Run	**Recovery Day**	**Aerobic Endurance**	**Strength and Conditioning**	**Strength Endurance**	**Recovery Day**	**Aerobic Endurance**
	Hard/Threshold		Steady/Endurance	Adaptation Phase	Steady/Endurance		Steady/Endurance
	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2 to Z3. Main Set: 2 x (10 mins in low Z4 + 3 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.	Allows for recovery whilst promoting adaptation to previous training stresses. Helps you get faster and keep injuries at bay.	All in low to mid Z2. These runs are to be done slowly. They will gradually build your endurance and increase your efficiency. If you do them faster, you'll increase your injury risk for no real benefit.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (90 secs in low Z5 up a hill + 2 min recoveries in Z1-Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The gradient should be 3 to 6%.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2. This is your long run and will gradually increase in duration. If you need to include some walking sections in these runs, in order to keep your heart rate down, that's fine.
SESSION 2							

Week 2

Build Phase 1: 4 hrs 39 mins

Phil's tip

When you're exercising for longer than about 70-80 minutes you need to consume carbohydrate during your workouts to stop your energy levels from dropping.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		45 mins	40 mins	45 mins	34 mins		1 hr 45 mins
	Recovery Day	Tempo Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Strength Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Endurance	Adaptation Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Threshold
		Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2 to Z3. Main Set: 3 x (7 mins in low Z4 + 2 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 8 mins in Z2. The intensity of these runs is at, or near to your 1-hour race effort.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 7 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 6 x (60 secs in low Z5 up a hill + 2 min recoveries in Z1-Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The gradient should be 3 to 6%.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 3

Build Phase 1: 4 hrs 51 mins

Phil's tip

During your Zone 2 workouts, you should theoretically feel able to chat throughout. If not, slow down.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		48 mins	45 mins	45 mins	33 mins		2 hrs
	Recovery Day	Tempo Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Strength Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Hard/Threshold	Steady/Threshold	Endurance Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Threshold
		Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2 to Z3. Main Set: 9 mins in low Z4 + 2 mins recovery in Z1, 8 mins in low Z4 + 2 mins recovery in Z1, 7 mins in low Z4 + 2 mins recovery in Z1. Warm Down: 8 mins in Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 6 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 6 x (60 secs in low Z5 up a hill + 2 min recoveries in Z1-Z2). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2. The gradient should be 3 to 6%.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 4

Active Recovery Week: 2 hrs 53 mins

Phil's tip

In my training plans, every 4th week is an active recovery week. This gives your body a chance to recover and adapt.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		30 mins	31 mins		27 mins	45 mins	40 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Tempo Run	Recovery Day	Speed Run	Strength and Conditioning	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Threshold	Hard/Threshold		V. Hard/VO2 Max	Endurance Phase	Steady/Threshold
	It's vital to make the most of this recovery week. You need to fully recover and start the next training phase feeling fresh and eager to train hard. There is enough training during the recovery week so that you won't lose fitness.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 12 mins in low Z4. Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.		Warm Up: 6 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z4 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (2 mins in Z5 + 60 secs in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 5

Peak Phase 1: 5 hrs 05 mins

Phil's tip

Want rapid email access to your own coach? Why not try my low-cost coaching program for 1-month free?
https://bit.ly/MPConemonthfree

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		40 mins	45 mins	45 mins	40 mins		2 hrs 15 mins
	Recovery Day	Speed Run	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Aerobic Endurance	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		V. Hard/VO2 Max	Steady/Threshold	Endurance Phase	Steady/Threshold		Steady/Threshold
		Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 7 x (60 secs in upper Z5 + 2 min recoveries in Z1). Warm Down: 5 mins in low Z2.	All in low to mid Z2.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 6

Peak Phase 1: 4 hrs 55 mins

Phil's tip

Find out more about your running form in my article:
What is Proper Running Form? https://bit.ly/MPCRunFormm

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		25 mins	50 mins	45 mins	40 mins		2 hrs 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Speed Run	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Threshold	Steady/Threshold	Strength Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Threshold
		All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 10 mins in Z2, 5 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 4 x (90 secs in upper Z5 with 3 min recoveries in Z1 to Z2). Warm Down: 7 mins in low Z2.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 7

Peak Phase 1: 4 hrs 02 mins

Phil's tip

Pacing is a key factor for success in racing.
How to Pace Your Marathon Race: https://bit.ly/PacingYourMarathon

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		30 mins	40 mins	45 mins	37 mins		1 hr 30 mins
	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance	Aerobic Endurance	Strength and Conditioning	Speed Run	Recovery Day	Aerobic Endurance
		Steady/Threshold	Steady/Threshold	Strength Phase	V. Hard/VO2 Max		Steady/Threshold
		All in low to mid Z2.	All in low to mid Z2. Ideally on a hilly route.	Please refer to the guide in Phil's Tips in Week 1.	Warm Up: 8 mins in Z2, 4 x (30 secs accelerating from Z2 to Z5 + 30 sec recoveries in Z1). Main Set: 3 x (2 mins in upper Z5 + 3 min recoveries in Z1 to Z2). Warm Down: 10 mins in low Z2.		Easy or steady run/jog all in low to mid Z2.
SESSION 2							

Week 8

Race Taper Week: 1 hrs 30 mins

Phil's tip

Good luck for your event! We'd love to hear about your training journey and race day experience, via our Instagram, Facebook or Reviews pages.

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SESSION 1		30 mins	30 mins		30 mins		Marathon
	Recovery Day	Taper Week Run	Taper Week Run	Recovery Day	Taper Week Run	Recovery Day	Race Day
		Steady/Threshold	Hard/Threshold		Steady/Threshold		
	This week you will maintain your fitness and eliminate any traces of fatigue. It's a good time to double check your race day logistics and strategies. If your race is on Saturday, move your Friday run to Thursday and take Friday as a rest day.	All in low to mid Z2.	Warm Up: 15 mins in Z2. Main Set: 3 x (60 secs in low Z4 + 2 mins in Z2). Warm Down. 6 mins in Z2.		All in low to mid Z2. If your race is on Saturday, move today's run to Thursday and take today as a rest day.		
SESSION 2							

Reviews

Perfect Plan!

Fantastic training plan from MyProCoach to lead to my first full-distance IRONMAN finish at Arizona in 2022. During the plan, I improved in all three disciplines and PR'd an IRONMAN 70.3 tuneup race by 11 min.

I'm an Unlimited Athlete and love having coach access & a premium membership with TrainingPeaks.

Josh Murphy
23 / 01 / 2023

It really works- trust the plan!

I exceeded my goal of not only finishing but well under my ideal goal. I 100% attribute this to Phil Mosley's 20-week 70.3 plan. I stuck to the plan and I'm beyond ecstatic to say I completed the IRONMAN 70.3 Puerto Rico!

The training truly changed my life and changed the way I think about things I'm able to do now.

I'm forever grateful.

Melissa Marston
21 / 03 / 2023

Love my Unlimited Athlete plan!

I've trained for two years with my Unlimited plan. The best part is that I can request my training plan at any moment!

I did IRONMAN Florida 70.3 last weekend, I'm feeling great and really happy with my result.

I totally recommend MyProCoach!

Ana Maria Pinzon Chatelain
16 / 12 / 2022

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1

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